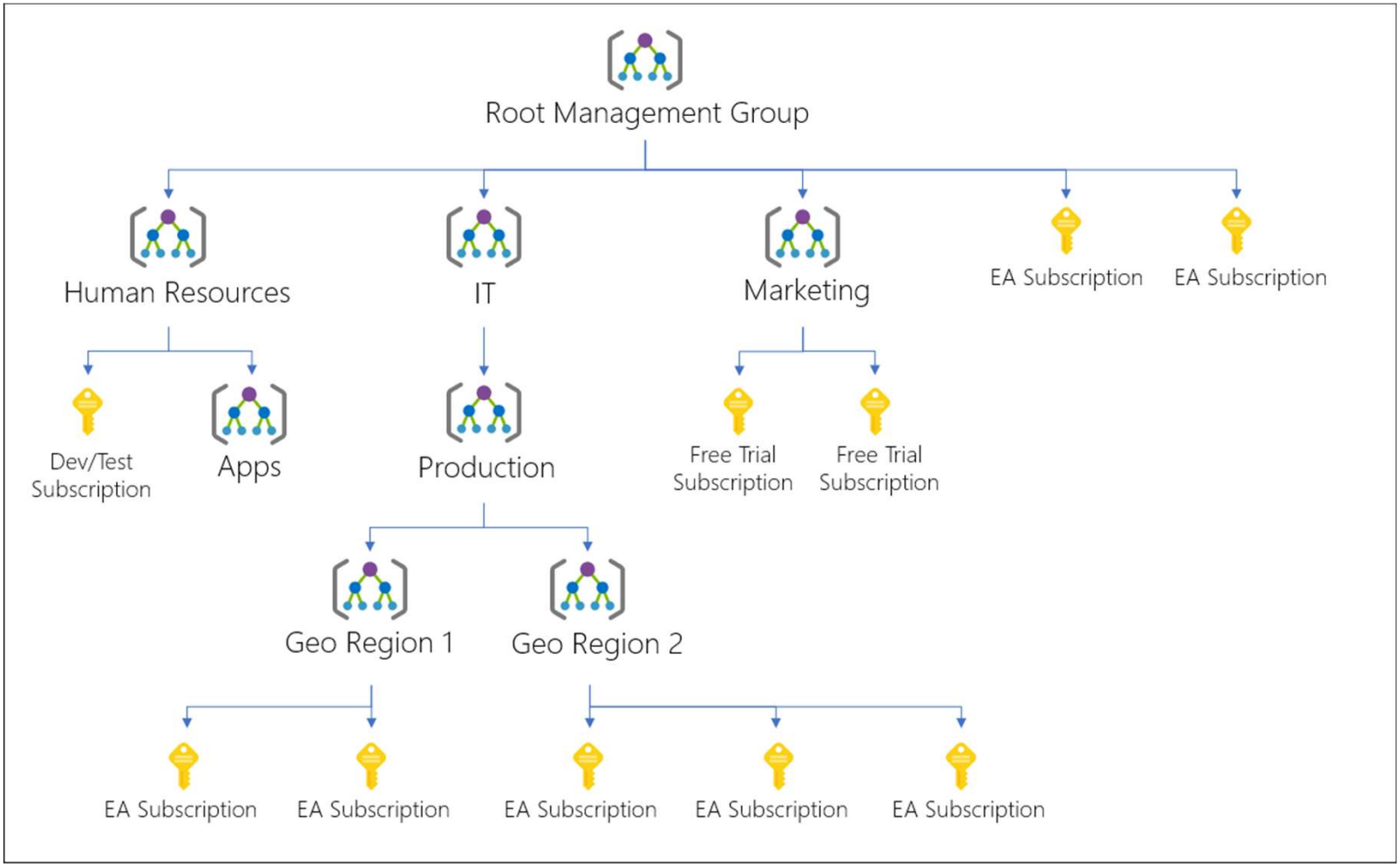
Management Group

What are Azure management groups?

- If your organization has many subscriptions, you may need a way to efficiently manage access, policies, and compliance for those subscriptions.
- Azure management groups provide a level of scope above subscriptions.
- You organize subscriptions into containers called "management groups" and apply your governance conditions to the management groups.
- All subscriptions within a management group automatically inherit the conditions applied to the management group.
- All subscriptions within a single management group must trust the same Azure Active Directory tenant.
- For example, you can apply policies to a management group that limits the regions available for virtual machine (VM) creation. This policy would be applied to all management groups, subscriptions, and resources under that management group by only allowing VMs to be created in that region.

✓ This security policy cannot be altered by the resource or subscription owner allowing for improved governance.
✓ If any user assigned any role at the management group level, his access will be inherited to all the subscription and resource level


Root Management Group
Human Resources
IT
Marketing
EA Subscription
EA Subscription
Dev/Test Subscription
Apps
Production
Free Trial Subscription
Free Trial Subscription
Geo Region 1
Geo Region 2
EA Subscription
EA Subscription
EA Subscription
EA Subscription
EA Subscription

Important facts about management groups

•10,000 management groups can be supported in a single directory.

•A management group tree can support up to six levels of depth.

- This limit doesn't include the Root level or the subscription level.

•Each management group and subscription can only support one parent.

•Each management group can have many children.

Root management group for each directory

- ✓ Each directory is given a single top-level management group called the "Root" management group.
- ✓ This root management group is built into the hierarchy to have all management groups and subscriptions fold up to it.
- ✓ By default, the root management group's display name is **Tenant root group**.
- ✓ To change the display name, your account must be assigned the Owner or Contributor role on the root management group.
- ✓ No one is given default access to the root management group. Azure AD Global Administrators are the only users that can elevate themselves to gain access. Once they have access to the root management group, the global administrators can assign any Azure role to other users to manage it.

Why would you need to elevate your access?

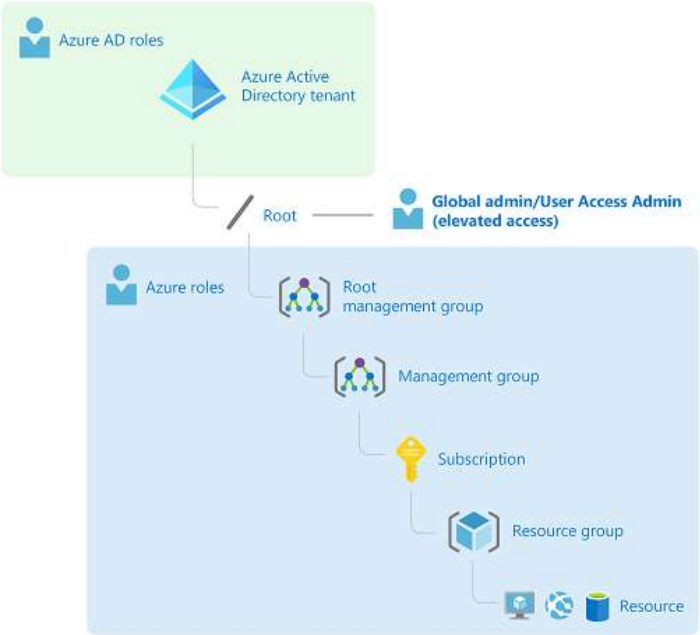
If you are a Global Administrator, there might be times when you want to do the following actions:

•Regain access to an Azure subscription or management group when a user has lost access

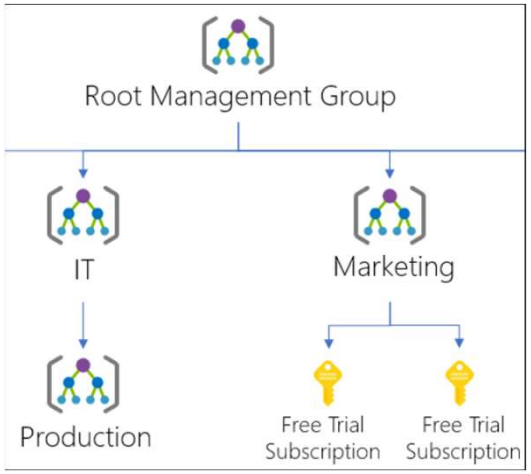
•Grant another user or yourself access to an Azure subscription or management group

•See all Azure subscriptions or management groups in an organization

•Allow an automation app (such as an invoicing or auditing app) to access all Azure subscriptions or management groups



Issues with breaking the role definition and assignment hierarchy path



Let's say there's a custom role defined on the Marketing management group. That custom role is then assigned on the two free trial subscriptions.
If we try to move one of those subscriptions to be a child of the Production management group, this move would break the path from subscription role assignment to the Marketing management group role definition.

In this scenario, you'll receive an error saying the move isn't allowed since it will break this relationship.
There are a couple different options to fix this scenario:
•Remove the role assignment from the subscription before moving the subscription to a new parent MG.
•Change the assignable scope within the role definition. In the above example, you can update the assignable scopes from Marketing to Root Management Group so that the definition can be reached by both branches of the hierarchy.